extraordinary powers to the soldiers and listed very harsh measures against Indians. The Indian government was convinced by the spies to issue a statement against the rules to mount psychological pressure/ Shekhawat said. The Indian government statement said:

While the ostensible reason for the decree is the seizure of illegal arms in Fiji, it is difficult to avoid the conclusion that the real motivation is political and that its provisions are likely to be used against the people of Indian origin as already evident from the individuals taken into preventive detention. The need in Fiji is for national reconciliation and promotion of harmony between the different ethnic groups in the interest of stability, peace and progress. The order should be rescinded, the political detainees released and civil liberty and democratic rights of all Fijians fully restored.

In July 1988, Malik and his team launched the second stage of the Fiji operation. A contact was developed in Australia's ruling Labour Party headed by Bob Hawke. The asset inside the government had close links with trade unions in Australia and Fiji. Malik and his band realised that Indian groups in Fiji at that time needed money more than anything else to fight Rabuka's oppressive regime.

'We give them what they want to start the massive agitation and mobilise support. We want Indians safe in Fiji. They have already suffered so much under the British. We need persistent protests to weaken Rabuka's position. We need to support Indian groups financially and by any other means required to fight the tyranny/ Malik told the asset.

The plan was carefully woven to ensure complete deniability. They wired the money through a front company to high profile